MODULE 4 | SESSION 16

Auditability and Workflow Narration

Make the path from request to result reconstructable.

AI-Accelerated Software Development | Foundations Program

Confidential. Prepared exclusively for Ensemble Health Partners.

A working result is not the same thing as an auditable result.

- Correct code can still be undocumented.
- A successful demo can still be non-reproducible.
- An approved change can still be impossible to defend later.
- The workflow has to leave evidence behind it.

Audit question

Could another engineer, auditor, or incident responder reconstruct why this change happened and how it was reviewed?

Bad answer

"The AI did it" is not a defensible explanation, ownership model, or compliance position.

Narration is part of the engineering record.

- What was asked?
- What was observed?
- What was changed?
- Why was this path chosen?
- What evidence supports the choice?

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Narration is not padding

- capture rationale
- document tradeoffs
- note uncertainty
- record review logic
- make later reconstruction possible
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Logs, traces, and narration serve different jobs.

Logs

Discrete events, tool execution, and outcomes.

Traces

The sequence and relationship of actions across a workflow.

Narration

The human justification, tradeoffs, and review context.

Enterprise requirement

When the decision path matters, all three have to work together.

If the team cannot retrieve the record later, the record was not captured well enough.

- Session logs.
- Session transcripts or export artifacts.
- PR descriptions and review comments.
- Trace IDs and event references.

Good retrieval standard

A reviewer who was not present can still reconstruct the decision path without private tribal knowledge.

Common failure

Leaving the rationale in a transient chat buffer and assuming the code speaks for itself.

Use the record signals Claude Code already exposes instead of relying on memory.

- Prompt correlation.
- Tool events.
- Session state.
- Checkpointing.
- Usage and audit controls.

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PR narration should answer

- why this change exists
- why this approach was chosen
- what evidence was checked
- what remains uncertain
- where the trace record lives
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The demo should show how trace evidence moves into a reviewable record.

Step 1

Export or capture the relevant Claude Code session record.

Step 2

Summarize the reasoning and tradeoffs in the PR narration.

Step 3

Attach or link the evidence so later review can reconstruct the path.

> The workflow becomes part of the product record, not an invisible side conversation.

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Delivery standard

- traceable
- explainable
- reviewable
- retrievable
- defensible later
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If the team cannot reconstruct the path, it cannot defend the path.

- Auditability is a delivery requirement, not compliance theater.
- Narration makes human ownership visible.
- Logs and traces make that ownership reviewable later.

Module 4 close

Module 4 secures execution, review, and evidence. The next module can assume those controls are in place for applied lab work.